ARDEN STATE BUDGET OFFICE — COMMENT ON SENATE BILL 214

Transmitted 30 April 2025

The Budget Office comments on the fund only, and on one point.

The bill establishes a dedicated fund of $12,000 million to be collected in up to five instalments. For scale, total state industry revenue in the most recent completed year was approximately $102,500 million and the State's own annual appropriation from all sources is a fraction of the fund.

The Office's concern is absorptive capacity. The fund may be spent only on projects within the State meeting the criteria in section 7-022(e). The Office is not aware of a pipeline of eligible projects of the order of the fund, and the bill does not permit the money to be applied elsewhere or returned.

The Office asked the Emergency Management Agency for the value of unrepaired documented damage. The Agency's answer is in the file. The Office observes that the fund substantially exceeds it and invites the Legislature to say what the balance is for.

The Office takes no position on the charges or on the constitutional questions.

Transmitted to the Committees on Finance and on Energy and Environment.